Bile

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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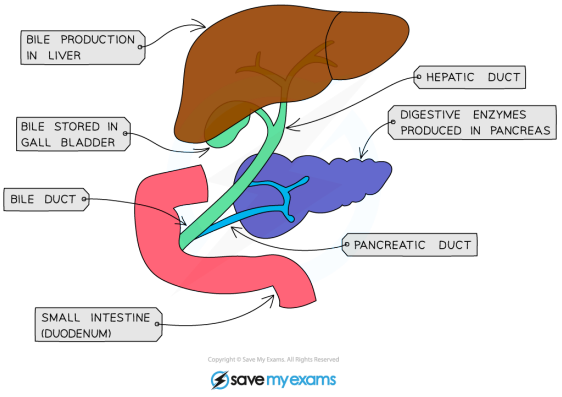
Bile: Extended

Extended Tier Only

- Cells in the liver produce bile which is then stored in the **gallbladder**



Bile production and secretion

Bile has two main roles:

- It is **alkaline** to **neutralise the hydrochloric acid** which comes from the stomach

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known as **emulsification**. The larger surface area allows lipase to chemically break down the lipid into glycerol and fatty acids faster

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Emulsification is the equivalent of tearing a large piece of paper into smaller pieces of paper. This is an example of **mechanical digestion**, not chemical digestion – breaking something into smaller pieces does not break bonds or change the chemical structure of the molecules which make it up, which is the definition of chemical digestion.

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